Connecting Somaliland Talent to the World: A Digital Employment Solution

Description of the Concept of the Mission:

My mission centers on easing unemployment in Somaliland by creating a digital platform that directly connects young, skilled individuals—many of whom already speak English and hold basic tech or professional abilities—with remote job openings from international companies. This effort ties closely to the broader employment challenges across Africa. Somaliland's population skews young, with over 70% under 30, and local unemployment rates for this group often exceed 70%, climbing to 75% in some 2025 assessments. Despite these hurdles, many youth bring real strengths like language skills and creativity that global employers seek for remote roles. A dedicated platform can unlock those strengths. It not only links people to work but also builds their capabilities, channels earnings back into communities, and promotes stability in a place still navigating post-conflict recovery and frequent climate issues.

Problem Statement:

Youth unemployment stands as a major, persistent challenge in Somaliland. Individuals aged 15–35 dominate the population at over 80%, yet job opportunities remain scarce for them. Local reports and 2025 estimates place youth unemployment at up to 75%, well above Sub-Saharan African norms. This job shortage fuels poverty, heightens social strains, and squanders potential talent. Urban spots like Hargeisa bear the brunt, though rural zones feel it too. Somaliland has rebuilt steadily since the 1991 civil war's end, but droughts, inflation surges, and the 2020s economic hits have deepened the issue. Key drivers include an education system that falls short of market demands—secondary completion hovers around 5%, with vocational options thin. Access to digital resources and worldwide job sites remains limited, compounded by nepotism, shaky infrastructure, and minimal internet engagement. Research highlights that avoiding the internet altogether boosts unemployment risks by over 60 times. Left unaddressed, this loop traps families in hardship (67% of Somalis survive below $1.90 daily) and stalls growth through reduced output, heavier remittance reliance, and heightened climate vulnerability.

Tools like the Somalia National Job Portal (jobs.gov.so) or Shaqodoon aid local placements but overlook remote global work, and miss Somaliland's edges, such as its diaspora ties and English proficiency. SomTalent shifts that by merging worldwide job feeds, quick skill courses, and culturally tuned features to effectively link local talent with global chances.

Software Development Model:

I selected the Agile methodology for this project because it matches the fast-changing realities of Somaliland's job market. Global remote work trends shift constantly, technology adoption varies widely, economic conditions fluctuate, and users provide direct feedback that changes priorities. Agile lets me build the solution step by step, test early, learn from real use, and adjust quickly instead of following a rigid, fixed plan. Unlike the Waterfall model, which demands complete detailed planning at the beginning and moves in strict sequential stages, Agile lowers risk. I deliver small pieces of working functionality regularly, gather input from users and stakeholders early, and make necessary changes without restarting the entire process. This approach works especially well for an innovative platform that tackles real challenges in a place where young people show high interest, but digital access and literacy levels differ greatly.

I apply the following core Agile practices:

1. Product Backlog Creation: I create a prioritized list of features using initial research and user needs. I place the most important items at the top: user registration, profile management, job search and matching, and training modules.
2. Sprint Planning: I organize the work into short sprints lasting 2–4 weeks. Each sprint targets only a few high-value tasks I can realistically complete—for example, building the registration user interface or adding backend logic for job matching.
3. Sprint Execution: I carry out development during each sprint. I monitor progress regularly so I spot and fix problems as soon as they appear.
4. Sprint Review and Retrospective: At the end of every sprint, I demonstrate the working pieces I completed. I collect feedback from users and stakeholders, then update the backlog based on what I learn. I also run a quick retrospective to review what went well, what did not, and how I can improve the process for the next sprint.
5. Continuous Integration and Frequent Releases. I integrate code often and test it continuously. Whenever a meaningful update becomes ready, I deploy it so real users can try it early. This habit keeps the platform adaptable and lets me respond to new requirements without delay.

The Hypothesis of the Solution:

With SomTalent live and gaining users, I see it linking at least 10,000 Somalilanders to remote jobs in year one. Active participants—those building profiles, applying often, and using training—should experience about 20% better job success, mostly from reaching roles they could not before.

The wins extend further as hired folks share tips on profiles, needed skills, remote talks, and

scam avoidance, spreading know-how via networks. Remote pay boosts remittances for steadier family support, and some will launch local ventures with the gained confidence. Over time, steady use could add 2–3% to employment-driven GDP growth, nudging the economy toward less aid dependence and more homegrown strength against droughts and costs. Ultimately, it creates a positive cycle: more jobs lead to improved skills and income, which in turn strengthen communities.

References:

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SomTalent

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January 17, 2026

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Revision History

Name	Date	Reason For Changes	Version
Sahra Omar	17/01/2026	Initial draft	1.0
Sahra Omar	19/02/2026	UML diagrams	2.0

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This SRS outlines requirements for SomTalent version 1.0, a web and mobile platform linking Somaliland talent to global remote jobs. It covers full system features, focusing on registration, matching, applications, and training to combat unemployment.

1.2 Document Conventions

Bold text is used to denote key terms, and requirements are assigned priorities to indicate their importance.
Priority levels are defined as

- **High** – must-have requirements
- **Medium** – important enhancements
- **Low** – optional or nice-to-have features

Each requirement statement has its **own priority.**

Tables are used to organize functional and non-functional requirements for clarity

1.3 Intended Audience and Reading Suggestions

Developers should read **Sections 3–5** for technical details and system requirements.

Project managers can focus on **Sections 1–2** for the project overview and scope.

Users and testers should review **Section 4** to understand system features and functional requirements.

Readers are encouraged to start with **Section 1** for general background information.

Sections 4 and 5 provide detailed functional and non-functional requirements and should be read next, depending on the reader's role.

1.4 Product Scope

SomTalent is a software platform designed to connect job seekers in Somaliland with global remote work opportunities. It allows users to create professional profiles, access skill-building courses, apply for jobs, and benefit from smart matching between their skills and available opportunities. The goal of the system is to improve employability, reduce youth unemployment, and create wider access to international work. By promoting digital inclusion and economic participation, the project also aligns with ALU's mission of developing African leadership and supporting sustainable economic growth.

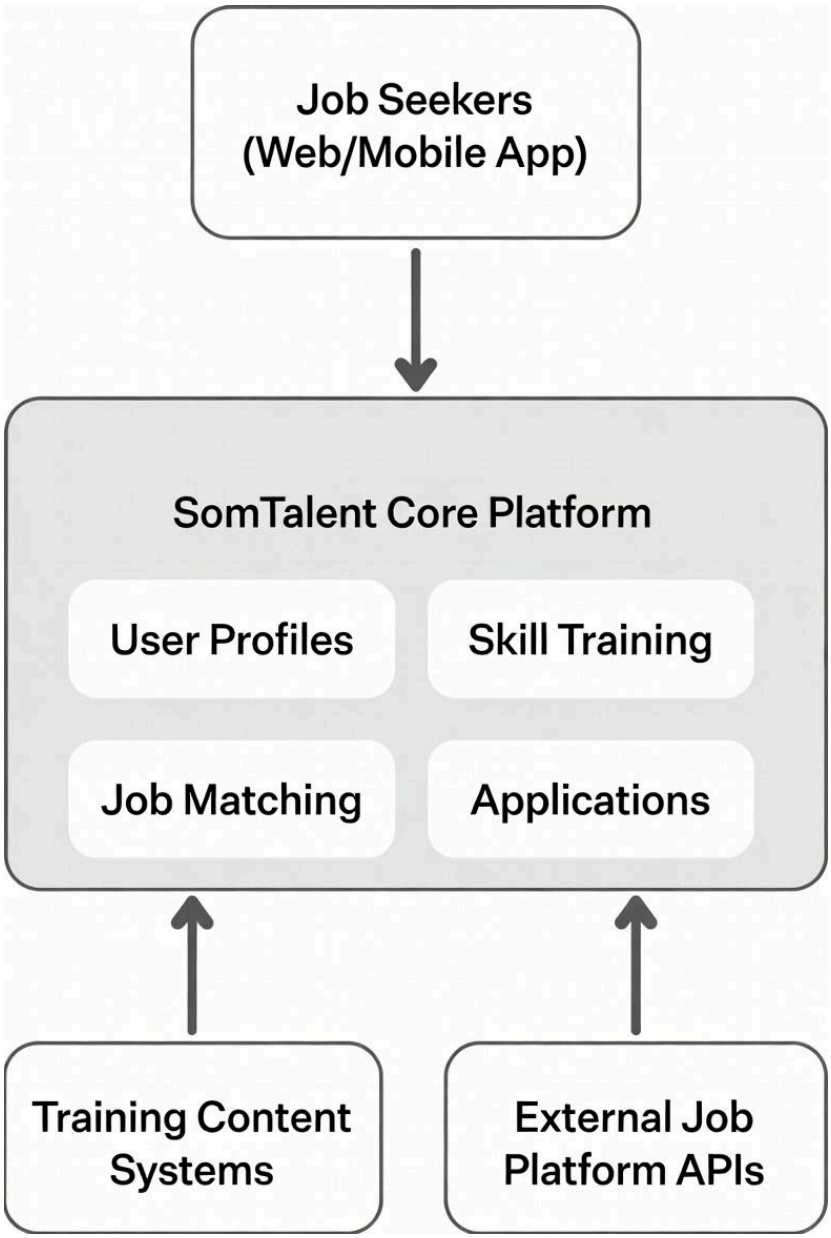
1.5 References

Amin, M. E., & Aden, A. M. (2025). Examining the determinants of youth unemployment in Somaliland. Applied Economics.

2. Overall Description

2.1 Product Perspective

SomTalent is a standalone software platform that builds on existing local job portals by adding a strong focus on global remote opportunities. It integrates with external job platforms through APIs and provides skill training and smart matching, helping bridge the gap between local talent and international work, especially in low-connectivity environments.



The diagram shows that job seekers mainly interact with the SomTalent core platform, where they create profiles, access training, get matched with jobs, and submit applications. It also highlights how SomTalent connects to external training providers and job platforms in the background to bring in the content and job data that make these features work.

2.2 Product Functions

- Secure registration and profiles.
- Job search with filters and recommendations.
- Easy applications.
- Skill modules with tracking.
- Employer postings and management.
- Dashboards for stats.

2.3 User Classes and Characteristics

Job Seekers:

- Main users are mostly youth with basic tech skills
- Frequent users
- Require a simple and easy-to-use interface.
- Focus on job opportunities and skill development

Employers:

- Global firms are posting job opportunities
- Less frequent users
- Access is verified and controlled.

Admins:

- ALU staff managing content and platform operations
- Expert users with full access
- Oversee system functionality and user management.

User Priorities:

- Job seekers' needs are the primary focus of the platform.

2.4 Operating Environment

Supported Browsers: Chrome, Edge, Firefox, Safari

Supported Mobile OS: Android 9+ and iOS 14+

Backend: Cloud-based (e.g., AWS)

Connectivity: Designed to handle low-bandwidth environments

2.5 Design and Implementation Constraints

- **Frontend Technology:** React
- **Backend Technology:** Node.js
- **Language Support:** English and Somali
- **Privacy & Compliance:** GDPR-aligned
- **Design Approach:** Mobile-first, targeting 80% youth users

2.6 User Documentation

- User Support Features:
    - In-app help
    - PDF guide
    - Video tutorials covering core features

2.7 Assumptions and Dependencies

- Users have stable internet, primarily in urban areas
- System depends on external APIs (e.g., LinkedIn, Upwork) for job listings
- No control over external API uptime or availability

3. External Interface Requirements

3.1 User Interfaces

Design Approach: Responsive design for desktop and mobile

Navigation: Intuitive menus and search bars

Language Support: Multilingual options (English and Somali)

Standards: Follows Material UI design guidelines

3.2 Hardware Interfaces

Supported Devices: Standard mobile phones and PCs

Peripheral Support: Webcams for interviews

3.3 Software Interfaces

Job Listings: Integrates LinkedIn API (v2.0)

Authentication: Uses Google OAuth for login

Payments: Integrates Premier Wallet for premium subscriptions

3.4 Communications Interfaces

Data Transmission: Secure via HTTPS

Email Notifications: Uses SMTP protocol

Real-Time Chat: Implements WebSockets

.

4. Requirement Specification

Stakeholder Requirements Specification

Functional Requirements

Req ID	Requirements	Description
FR 1	**User Registration**	Users sign up securely with email or phone number
FR 1.1	Profile Creation	Users enter skills, work history, upload a resume and a photo
FR 1.2	Profile Editing and Verification	Users edit information and complete basic verification steps
FR 2	**Job Search and Matching**	Users filter jobs by skills, category, remote status and salary range
FR 2.1	Intelligent Matching	System recommends the most relevant jobs based on the user's profile
FR 2.2	Application Submission	Users apply quickly with pre-filled profile information
FR 3	**Skill-Building Modules**	Platform delivers short courses on in-demand topics
FR 3.1	Progress Tracking and Certification	System tracks completion and issues digital certificates
FR 4	**Employer Functionality**	Verified employers post jobs, review applications, and contact candidates
FR 4.1	Application Management	Employers sort, shortlist candidates, and schedule interviews
FR 5	**User and Admin Dashboard**	Users view personal statistics; Admin access usage reports

5. Other Nonfunctional Requirements

Non-Functional Requirements

Requirement Type	Req ID	Description
Performance	NFR 1	The system should respond to user actions within 3 seconds under normal conditions and support 1,000 to 10,000 concurrent users without major redesign
Usability	NFR 2	The interface should be intuitive and mobile-first, letting users complete key tasks like searching and applying for jobs in three steps or fewer, with English as the primary language and Somali translations for profile, job search, and training screens.
Security	NFR 3	All data must use HTTPS and be encrypted at rest, with secure authentication, role-based access control for users, and protection against common security threats following OWASP guidelines.
Reliability	NFR 4	The platform must maintain at least 99% uptime (excluding maintenance) and perform daily automated backups to protect user data.
Scalability	NFR 5	The architecture must handle a 50% increase in active users within six months without major changes to the core design.
Compatibility	NFR 6	The web interface must work on the latest Chrome, Firefox, Edge, and Safari browsers, and the mobile interface must be

Requirement Type	Req ID	Description
		fully responsive on Android 9+ and iOS 14+ devices.
Maintainability	NFR 7	The codebase must be modular, well-documented with meaningful comments, and easy for future developers to understand and extend.
Auditability and Privacy	NFR 8	The system must log key user and system actions for administration while allowing users to view, edit, export, or delete their personal data in line with data protection principles.

6. Appendix

No additional requirements at this stage.

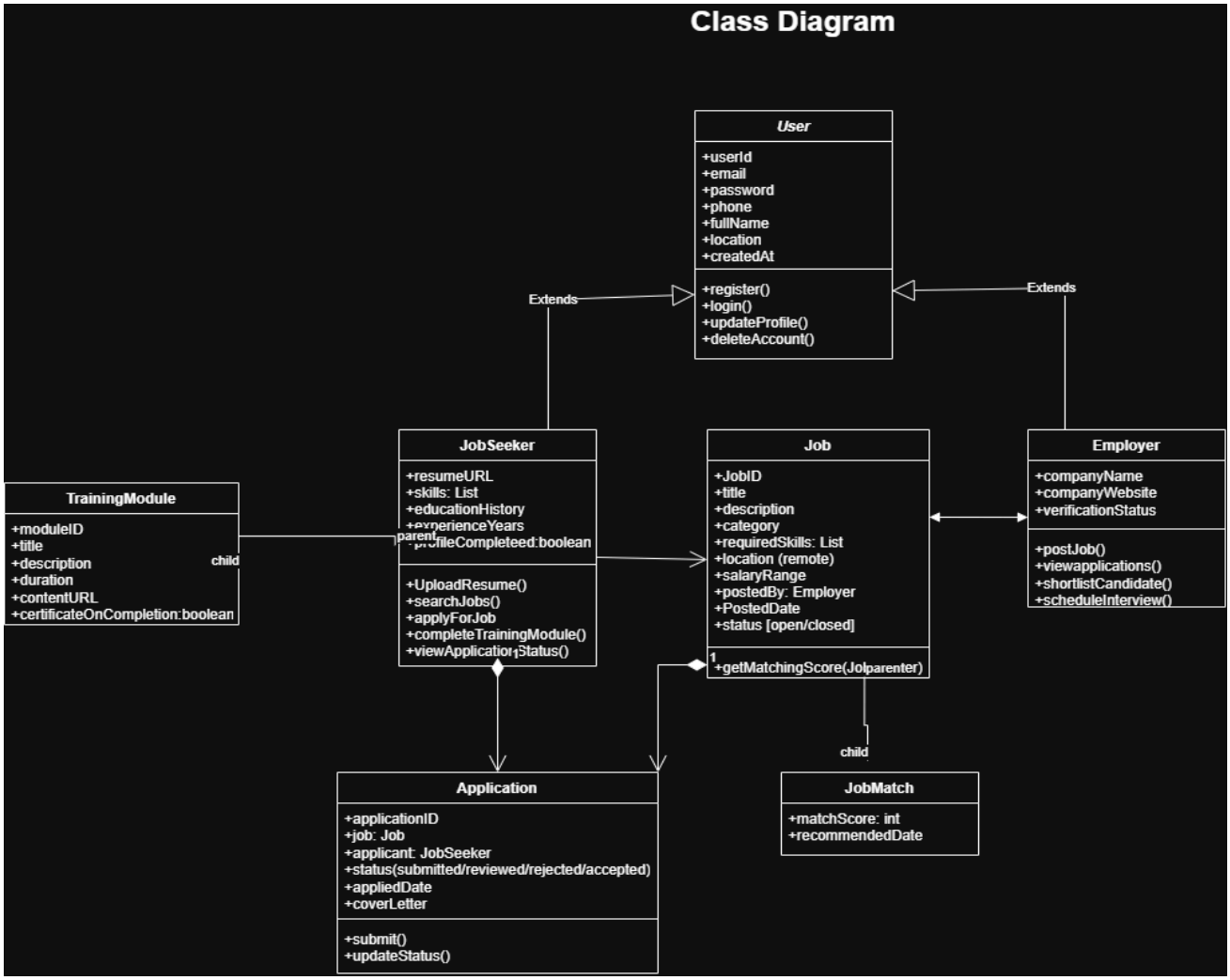
Appendix A: Glossary

Diaspora: Somalilanders living abroad who maintain ties to home.

Remote Work: Jobs performed online without the need for a physical location.

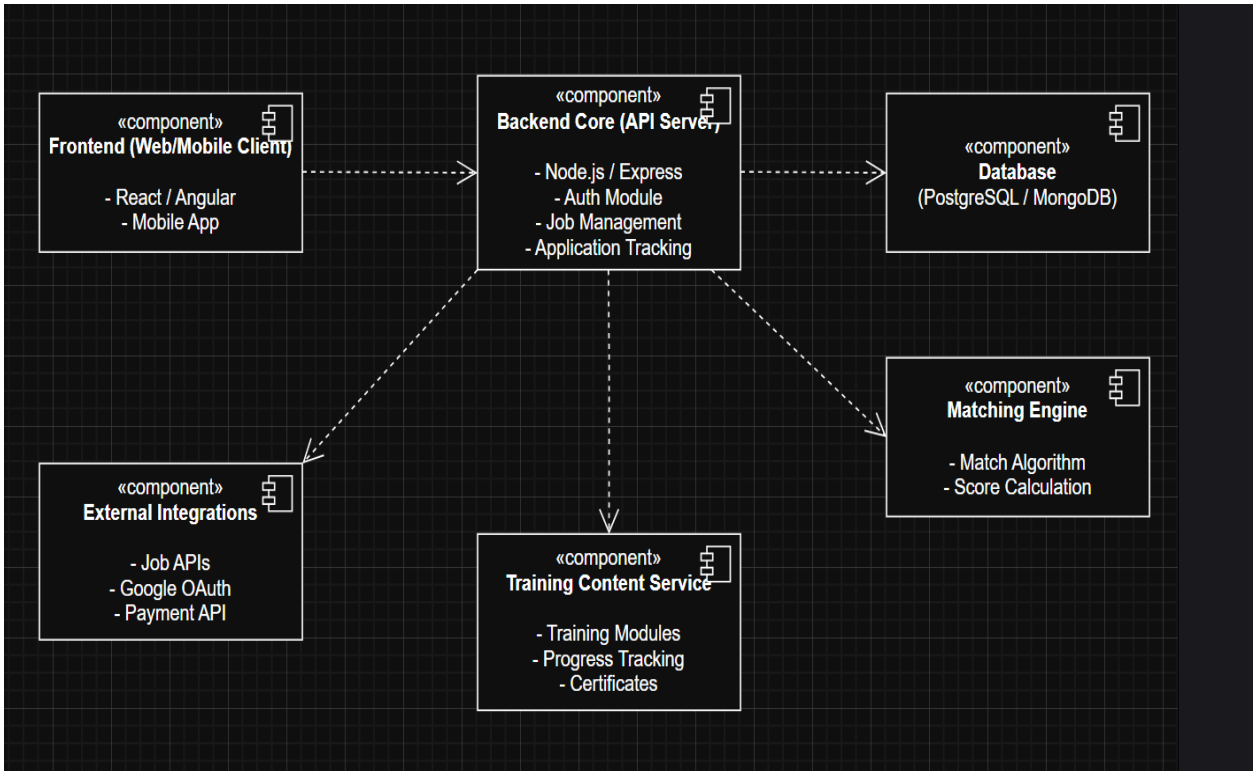
Appendix B: UML Diagrams

Class Diagram:



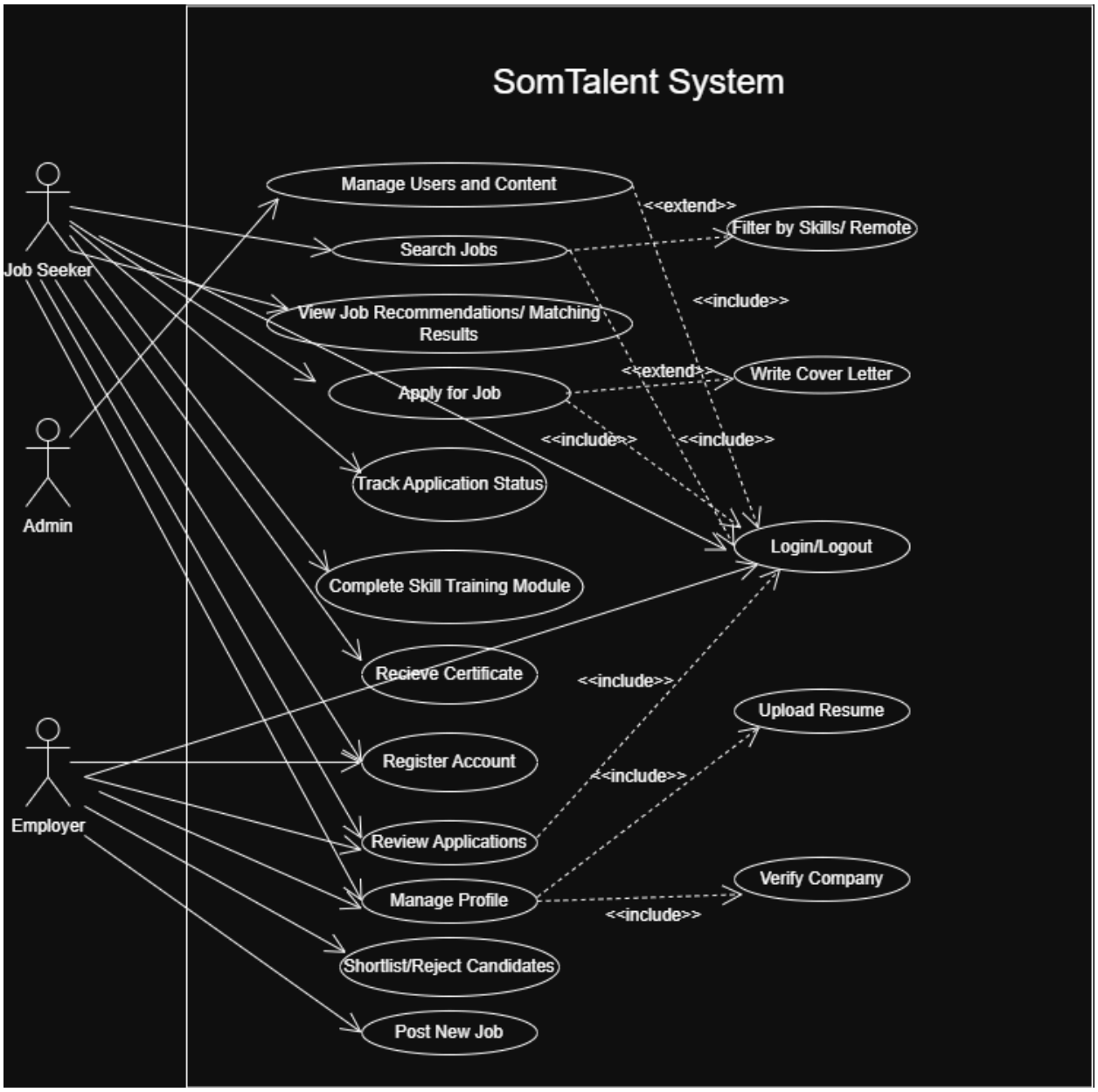
This is a class diagram, and it explains how different parts of the system are connected and organized internally. It shows the structure of the system. It includes classes like User, JobSeeker, Employer, Job, Application, JobMatch, and TrainingModule. It also shows their attributes, methods, and relationships.

Component Diagram:



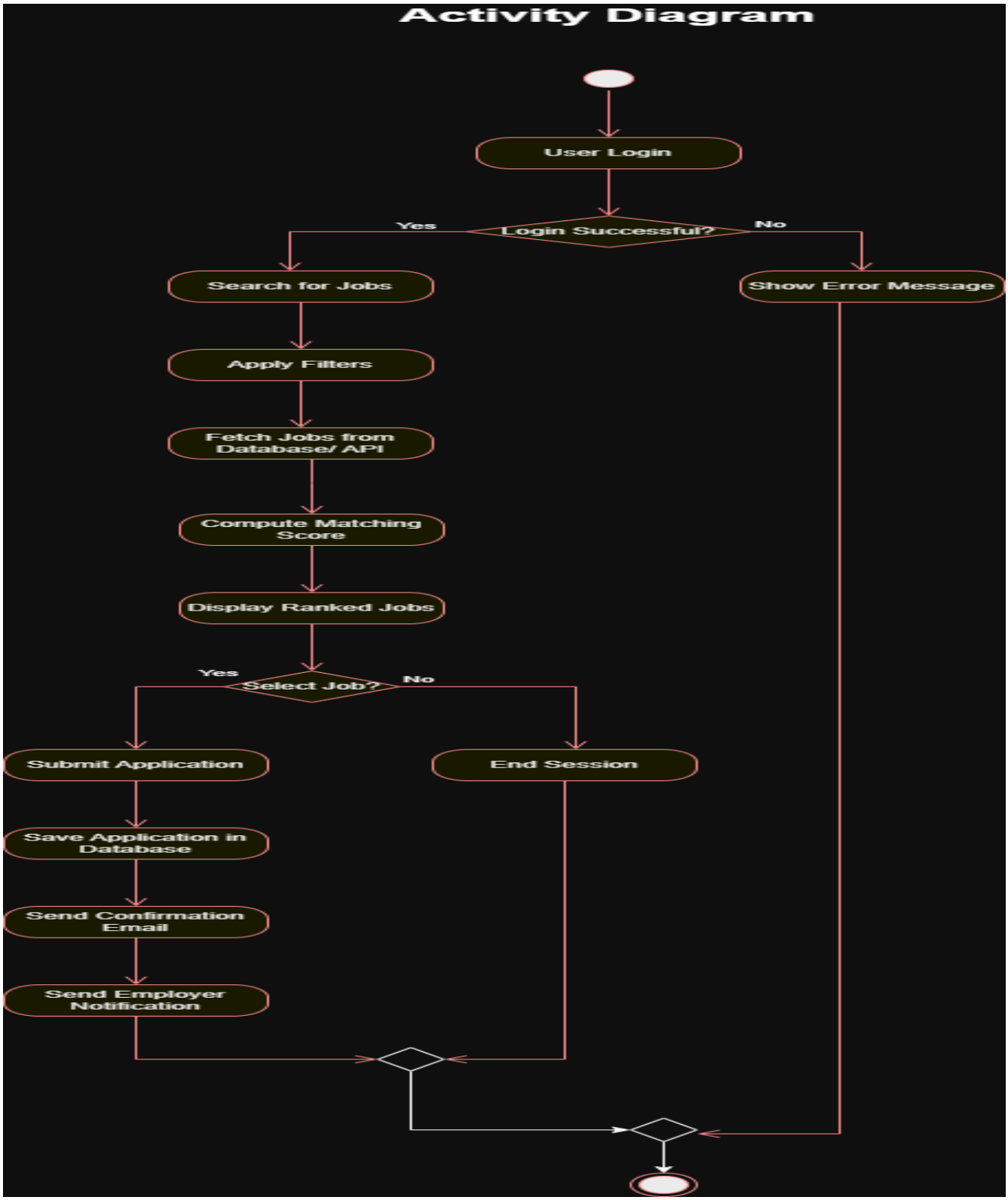
This is a component diagram, and it focuses on the system's overall structure and organization. It shows the main parts of the system and how they are connected. It includes components such as the user interface, application service, job matching module, training module, and database. It also shows how these components communicate with each other to make the system function properly.

Use Case Diagram:



This is a use case diagram, and it gives a general overview of the system's functionalities from the user's point of view. It shows the main users of the system and what they can do. As seen in the diagram, in this system the two main actors are the jobSeeker and the employer. The jobSeeker can register, log in, search for jobs, apply for jobs, and complete training modules. The employer can post jobs, view applications, and manage candidates.

Activity Diagram:



This is an activity diagram, and it explains how the process flows from start to end. It shows the step-by-step flow of how the system works. It starts with the user logging in, then searching for jobs, applying filters, viewing ranked jobs, and submitting an application. It also shows decision points like login success or selecting a job.